Be sure to create a file called synonyms.txt under $ELASTICSEARCH_HOME/config with the following contents.

**Listing 7.54 synonyms.txt file with a set of synonyms**

```
important=>imperative
beautiful=>gorgeous
```

We can call the file using a relative or absolute path; a relative path points to the config directory of Elasticsearch's installation folder. We can test this analyzer by invoking the `_analyze` API with the following input.

**Listing 7.55 Testing the synonyms**

```
POST index_with_synonyms_from_file_analyzer/_analyze
{
  "text": "important",
  "tokenizer": "standard",
  "filter": ["synonyms_from_file_filter"]
}
```

We get the token "imperative" as the response, proving that the synonyms are picked up from the synonyms.txt file we dropped in the config folder. You can add more values to this file while Elasticsearch is running and try them, too.

That's a wrap! This chapter is fundamental for the discussion of search that we embark on in the next chapter. We have completed all the necessary background to work with search functionality in depth.

## Summary

- Elasticsearch analyzes `text` fields via the text analysis process. Text analysis is carried out using either built-in or custom analyzers. Non-text fields are not analyzed.
- Text analysis consists of two phases: tokenization and normalization. Tokenization splits the input field into individual words or tokens, and normalization enhances the word (for example, changing it to a synonym, stemming it, or removing it).
- Elasticsearch employs a software module called an analyzer to carry out text analysis. An analyzer is a package made of character filters, token filters, and a tokenizer.
- Elasticsearch uses a `standard` analyzer by default if no analyzer is given explicitly during indexing and searching. A `standard` analyzer employs no character filter, a `standard` tokenizer, and two token filters (`lowercase` and `stop`), although the `stop` filter is off by default.
- Every analyzer must have one (and only one) tokenizer, but it can have zero or more character or token filters.